consciousness, infinite', which both ascribes essential properties and distinguishes *Brahman* from contingent and finite beings.

Further reading: Bartley 2002; Lipner 1986

Buddhi (intellectual faculty): the ***Samkhya-Yoga***, ***Vedanta***, ***Pratyabhijna*** and ***Shaiva-Siddhanta*** philosophical schools use the term *buddhi* (or *antah karana* – inner sense) for the psychological faculty whose modifications (*vritti*) are our thoughts and feelings. It is an emergent product of primal material nature (*prakriti*) that becomes conscious when irradiated by the consciousness that belongs to the soul (***atman***) that has become associated with a body. The combination of the light of consciousness and the activity of the intellect contributes to the formation of individual embodied personality. The operations of the *buddhi* are our internal mental life. As a composite of matter and consciousness it mediates between the inner spiritual essence and the material environment.

Anti-Buddhist thinkers differentiate transitory mental events comprising a stream of consciousness from the constant soul. They distinguish transient psychological episodes (*buddhi-vritti*) whose nature is definite awareness perception (*adhyavasaya*) from permanent background subjective awareness (*samvid*) of whose beginning and end we have no experience. The former are variable because they occur in the essentially material and mutable mind. The latter is the constant awareness (*samvedana*) of oneself as the same subject of experience, and it is a constitutive feature of the human condition.

Further reading: Goodall 1998; Hiriyanna 1993; Larson and Bhattacharya 1987; Mayeda 1979; Torella 2002